

Afghan Women: The Struggle with Poverty and the Path to Resolution

Afghanistan ranks 170th out of 170 countries for women's inclusion, justice and security – perhaps it's far more than that?

Poverty Situation of Afghan Women:

Since the Taliban regained control in August 2021, Afghanistan's economic activity appears to have remained at a low level, accompanied by severe poverty and unemployment. Sixty-nine percent of Afghans are insecure in terms of livelihood, facing a lack of necessary livelihood resources. Compared with men, Afghan women are in a more severe situation. They consume less food now and are suffering from more severe income inequality. The proportion of women employed in all industries in Afghanistan has dropped significantly, from 11 percent in 2022 to 6 percent in 2023, almost halved. Restrictions on women's job opportunities have caused economic losses of up to \$1 billion, accounting for about 5 percent of Afghanistan's GDP.

International Aid:

The United Nations Development Programme office in Afghanistan emphasizes that Afghanistan's socio-economic recovery depends on the provision of international aid, the revitalization of the production sector, and the restoration of women's rights. The United Nations Refugee Agency, the United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization, and UN Women have launched a joint initiative to enhance women-led organizations, improve women's self-reliance, and thereby improve the overall quality of life and resilience of Afghan women.

Prospects:

"The internet is our last hope, nothing can replace true freedom," says Beheshta, a 24-year-old Afghan woman. Humanitarian organizations around the world should strengthen the construction of the internet in Afghanistan, allowing more Afghan women to learn and work through the internet. At the same time, Afghan women should strengthen the construction of women's organizations, jointly fighting for women's rights.

"An Entire Population Pushed into Poverty in Afghanistan." International Rescue Committee. Retrieved from.

References:

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